DICE & DIVE

Dive a dungeon floor by floor with a party of heroes, then roll your loot as real dice for combos and multipliers

DUNGEON DIVE | AUTO-BATTLE + MANUAL SPECIALS | DICE-ROLL REWARD GAME | PORTRAIT MOBILE · UNITY

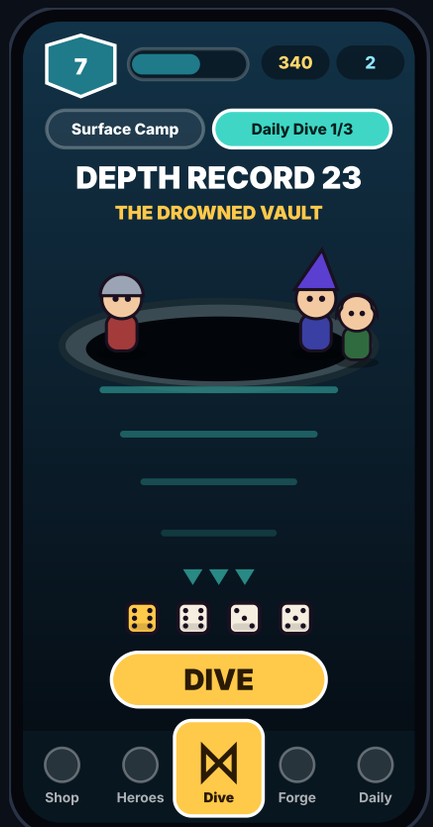
Design goal

Cup Heroes' loop, but every reward is a dice roll you control.

Auto-battle for players who want to relax, tap-to-roll specials for players who want to play.

Reading Key

- SOURCED From a cited source (Sources page)
- PROPOSED Design proposal: ours to change
- TUNE A starting number to tune in playtests
- Combo odds are computed exactly for 5 six-sided dice. All art is placeholder SVG



Surface Camp: one big DIVE button



Dive Roll: hold, reroll, score the combo

Not a copy

What we keep and change from Cup Heroes (p.2)

The run

Dive, fight, boons (p.3–5)

The Dive Roll

The minigame, odds and tuning (p.6–7)

Meta & build

Heroes, store, Unity build order (p.8–10)

1. NOT A 1:1 COPY

Same Rhythm, Different Game

	Cup Heroes (observed)	Dice & Dive
Run shape	Chapters of waves	A **dive**: floors downward, bosses every 5, camps to surface from
Fights	Auto-battle	Auto-battle + **x2 speed**, plus optional **tap-to-roll class specials**
Upgrade picks	3 cards: stat boosts	3 cards that **change how dice behave** (exploding 6s, loaded die…)
Reward minigame	Balls through a pachinko board	**Dive Roll**: roll 5 dice, hold, reroll, score combos
Risk	None in the minigame	**Dive Deeper**: re-roll for more, but 2+ skulls costs the bonus
Hero growth	Levels, gear, pets, ascension	Levels + a **Dice Forge** (d6 → d8 → d10 → d12 attack die)
Currencies	4+ (coins, gems, tokens, pass points)	**2**: Coins and Forge Shards
Store	Gems, packs, timed bundles, pass	**About 4 items**: support pack, cosmetics, optional ads

Keep the rhythm

Action → choice → reward → upgrade → return. Short fights on one readable screen. One big button per screen. This is genre structure, not Cup Heroes' property.

Replace the signature

Cup Heroes' identity is its cup-and-ball board. Ours is **dice you hold and reroll**: the player makes a decision instead of only watching physics.

Add what they don't have

A push-your-luck dive, class specials you can play by hand, and dice that grow with the hero. These are the three things a screenshot should show.

2. THE DIVE

Go Deeper. Know When to Surface.

DIVE Start at floor 1 › **FIGHT** Auto waves › **BOON** Pick 1 of 3 › **BOSS** Every 5 floors › **DIVE ROLL** Roll the chest › **CAMP** Surface or go on › **FORGE** Spend at the top

PROPOSED **Structure**

Each floor is 3–5 short waves. A boss every 5th floor opens a chest that you resolve with the **Dive Roll**. Camps on floors 3, 6, 9... let you **surface** and bank everything.

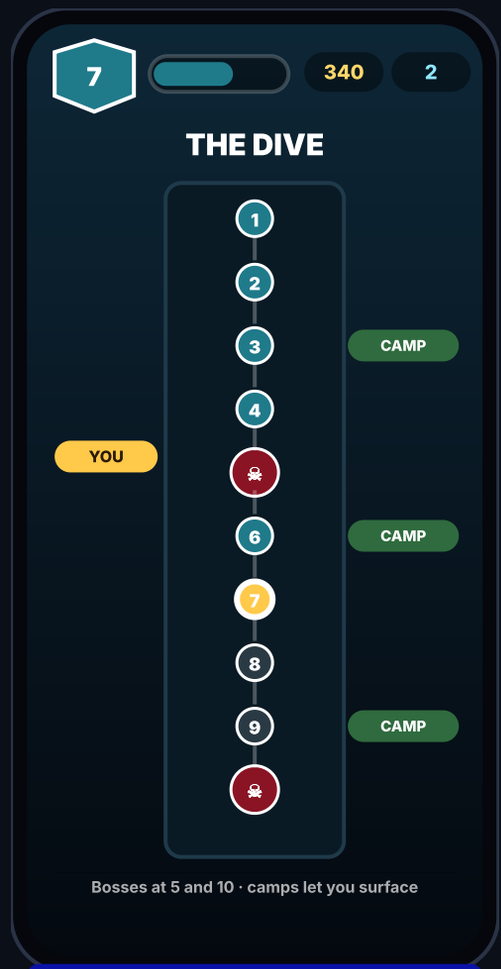
PROPOSED **The tension**

Coins you carry are at risk: wiping out keeps **50%** TUNE. Banked coins are safe. So every camp asks: surface now, or push for the next boss chest?

PROPOSED **Depth record**

Your deepest floor is the headline number on the home screen and in the daily leaderboard. It's the 'one more run' hook.

This is the extract-or-push idea from The Last Lantern, and what Web of Dice already does with the Guild walk-back, here as the main structure.



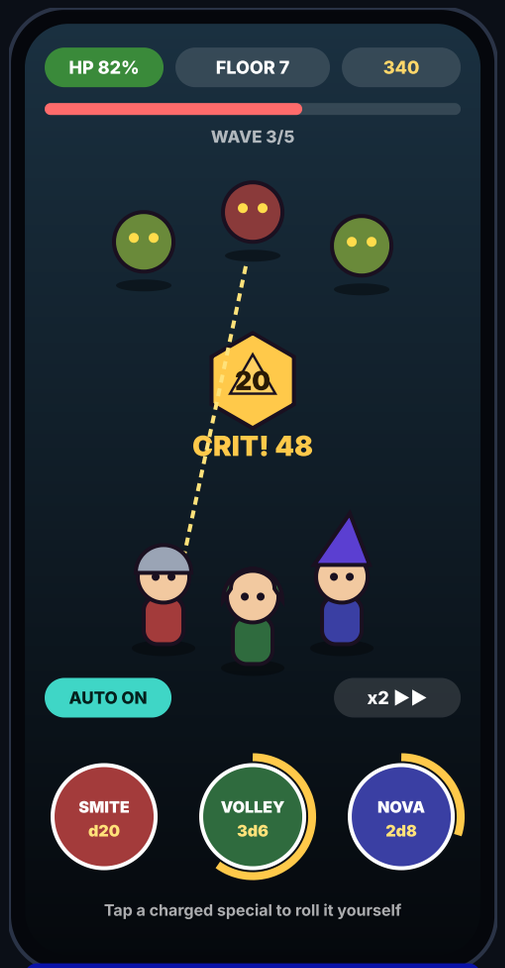
Depth map: floors, bosses, safe camps



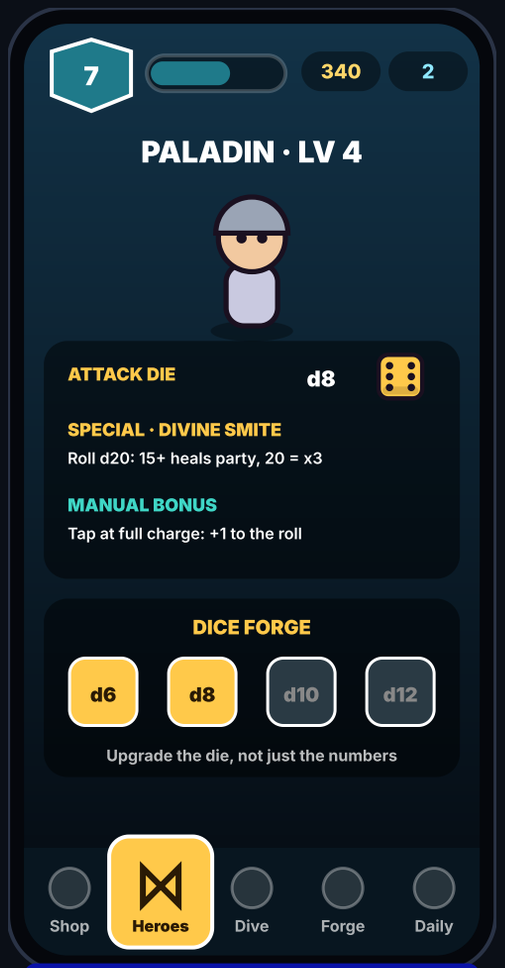
Dive Deeper: the push-your-luck beat

3. COMBAT

Auto for Some, Hands-On for Others



Battle: auto + speed, or tap specials



Hero screen: attack die, special, forge

PROPOSED **Auto mode (default)**

Heroes fight on their own. **x1 / x2 speed** toggle (x3 as a later unlock). Specials fire automatically when charged. Fully playable one-handed or while half-watching.

PROPOSED **Manual specials**

Each class has one special with its own dice (Paladin: Smite d20, Ranger: Volley 3d6, Wizard: Nova 2d8). In manual mode **you tap it** at full charge, choose the moment, and the roll gets **+1** TUNE. Auto players lose a little; nobody is forced to tap.

PROPOSED **Dice on screen**

Every hit shows its die result. A natural 20 or max roll gets a gold flash, big number and screen shake. Damage numbers read as dice, not just stats.

PROPOSED **Party**

3 heroes, 4 classes at launch: **Fighter, Rogue, Cleric, Wizard** (GPT's scope cut: four good classes beat eight shallow ones).

4. DICE BOONS

Upgrades That Bend the Dice

Cup Heroes' cards add numbers. Ours change the *rules of the dice*, so builds feel different, not just bigger.

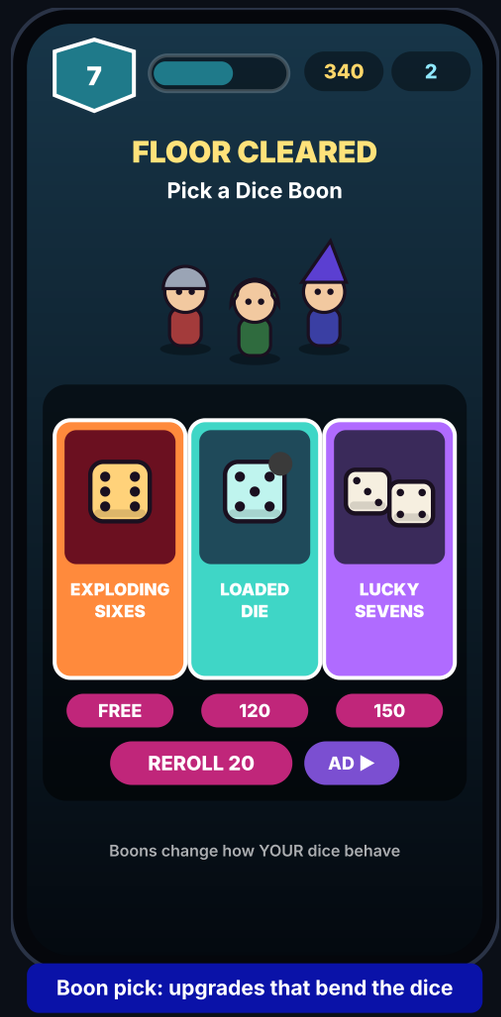
PROPOSED Example boons

- **Exploding Sixes**: a 6 rolls again and adds
- **Loaded Die**: your lowest die each roll gets +1
- **Lucky Sevens**: any two dice summing to 7 heal the party
- **Snake Eyes**: skulls (1s) deal damage instead of missing
- **High Roller**: +50% damage on max rolls, −1 to all others
- **Steady Hand**: one extra Hold-and-reroll in the Dive Roll

PROPOSED Run economy

Coins earned in fights buy boons (prices on the cards, one free pick). Reroll the offer for 20 coins or one optional ad, as in Cup Heroes.

Boons should also touch the **Dive Roll** (Steady Hand, Exploding Sixes), so the build you made in combat changes the minigame. That's how the two halves of the game feed each other.



Boon pick: upgrades that bend the dice



Battle: auto + speed, or tap specials

5. THE DIVE ROLL

The Minigame: Roll Your Loot

PROPOSED How it works

- A boss chest becomes **5 dice** (more with boons)
- **Throw**: swipe up to toss them into the tray
- **Hold** any dice by tapping, then **reroll** the rest once
- **Lock in**: the best combo multiplies the chest
- Optional: **Dive Deeper** for more (next page)

Combo (5 dice, one roll)	Chance	Multiplier
Nothing	6.2%	x1
Pair	46.3%	x2
Two pair	23.1%	x3
Three of a kind	15.4%	x4
Straight (1–5 or 2–6)	3.1%	x6
Full house	3.9%	x6
Four of a kind	1.9%	x10
Five of a kind: JACKPOT	0.08%	x25

Odds are exact for one throw of 5d6 (all 7,776 outcomes counted). The average multiplier on one throw is about **x2.9**, before holding and rerolling, which raises it. TUNE multipliers in playtests.



Dive Roll: hold, reroll, score the combo



Dive Deeper: the push-your-luck beat

6. DIALING IN THE MINIGAME

Where the Feel Comes From

PROPOSED Dive Deeper (push your luck)

- After locking in, choose **Surface** (keep it) or **Dive Deeper**
- Dive: roll 5 fresh dice; their combo multiplier is **added** on top
- **2 or more skulls (1s)** = bust: lose the dive bonus, keep the base
- Bust chance per dive: **19.6%** (exact, 5d6)
- Cap at 3 dives TUNE

PROPOSED Juice checklist

- Real tumbling dice: 3D dice in a 2D scene, or physics on 2D sprites
- Slow-motion on the last die to settle
- Held dice lift and glow gold
- Combo name stamps on screen; multiplier counts up
- Distinct sound per combo tier; JACKPOT gets the big one
- Haptic tick on each die landing

PROPOSED Prototype tests

- Does holding feel like a real choice? Watch whether testers hesitate
- Is a pair (46%) still exciting? If not, make pairs x1.5 and spread the rewards upward
- Does Dive Deeper get chosen about half the time? If almost always or never, retune the bust rule
- Time per Dive Roll: target 8–12 seconds

SOURCED **Why this can work:** Balatro, a roguelike built on scoring poker hands, made about $4.4M on mobile in its first two months as a $9.99 premium game (AppMagic via PocketGamer.biz). Players clearly enjoy building and scoring combos. SOURCED Space Rock Breaker shows a small game built around a Plinko-style reward board can find an audience; our version swaps the board for dice.

7. META & ECONOMY

Two Currencies. Dice That Grow.

PROPOSED **Coins**

Earned in fights and the Dive Roll. Banked when you surface. Spent on hero levels and boons.

PROPOSED **Forge Shards**

From bosses and five-of-a-kind jackpots. Spent in the Dice Forge.

PROPOSED **Dice Forge**

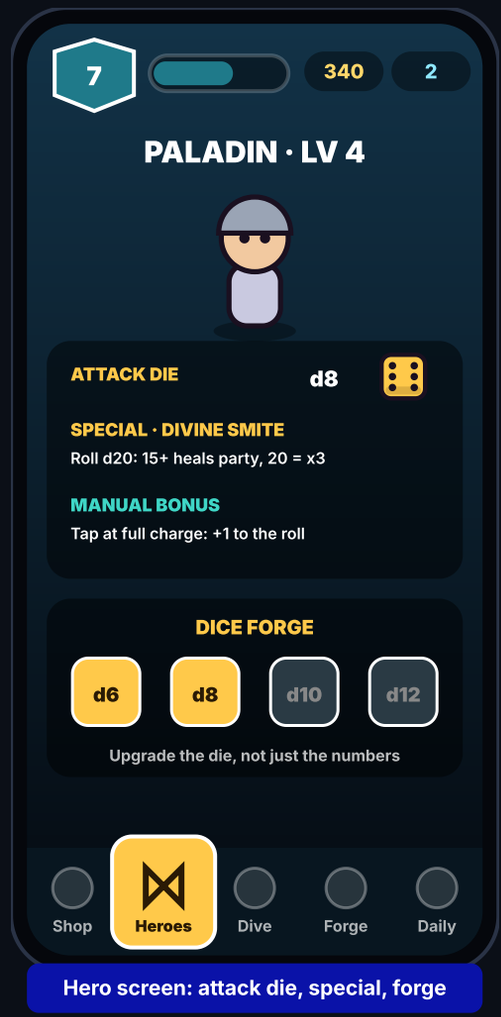
Upgrade each hero's attack die: **d6 → d8 → d10 → d12**. Bigger dice mean bigger rolls, and the upgrade is visible on every hit.

PROPOSED **Retention**

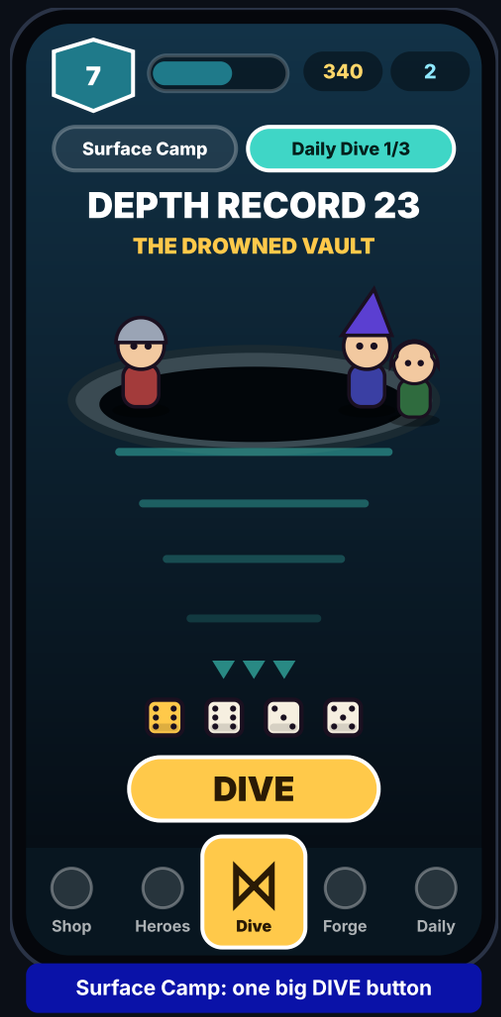
Daily Dive (seeded floor set + leaderboard), a 7-day calendar, depth-record milestones that unlock heroes.

Kept out on purpose

- Premium gems
- Random paid packs or shards
- Stamina or energy
- Countdown bundles
- Forced interstitial ads



Hero screen: attack die, special, forge



Surface Camp: one big DIVE button

8. MONETIZATION

Small, Fair, Optional

1 · Rewarded ads optional

One extra Dive Roll reroll, one revive per dive, or a boon-offer refresh. Capped per day.

2 · Diver's Support Pack $4.99 one-time

No forced ads, a brass dice set, +1 permanent Dive Roll reroll.

3 · Cosmetics $0.99–$1.99

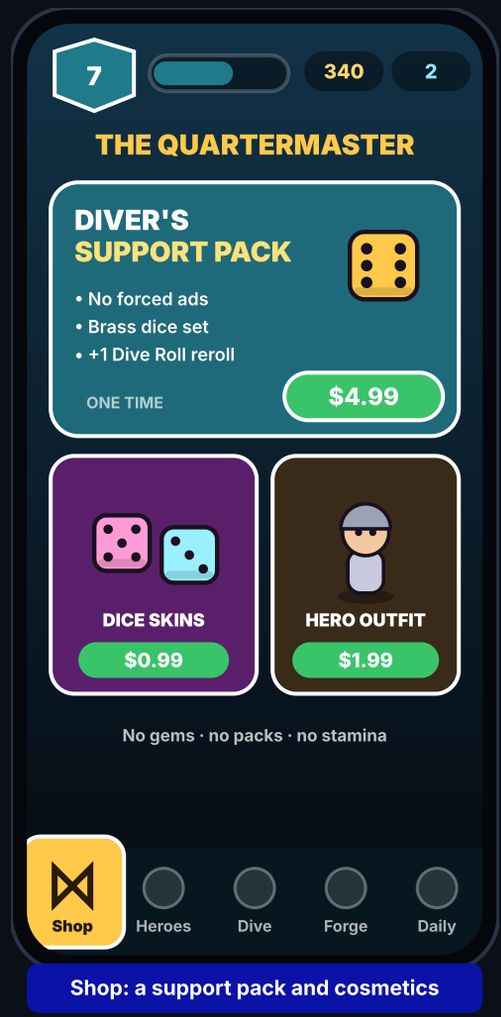
Dice skins (the most visible item in the game) and hero outfits.

4 · Later: Dive Pass $3.99 / season

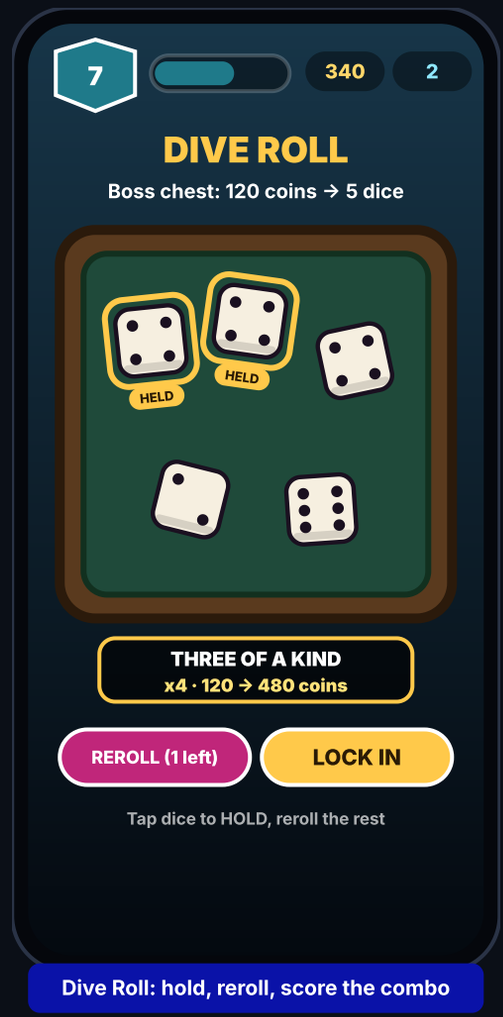
Only after retention is proven; premium track cosmetic only.

RULE: NO PAYWALL ON CORE POWER

SOURCED Comparable light model: Soul Knight sells $0.99–$3.99 unlocks (Adapty estimate, ~$400K/month). INFERRED Dice skins suit this game unusually well, because the dice are on screen in every fight and every reward.



Shop: a support pack and cosmetics



Dive Roll: hold, reroll, score the combo

9. BUILD ORDER IN UNITY

Minigame First, Everything Else After

Step 1 · The Dive Roll scene

- Standalone scene: 5 dice, throw, hold, reroll, lock in
- Combo detection + multiplier count-up
- Dive Deeper with the skull bust rule
- Debug panel: dice count, multipliers, bust rule live-editable
- **Pass:** testers play it 10 times in a row without being asked

Step 2 · One floor of combat

- 3 heroes vs waves, auto-battle, x2 speed
- One manual special (Paladin Smite) to test tap-to-roll
- 3-card boon pick with 6 boons
- One boss → opens the Dive Roll
- **Pass:** a full floor-to-chest loop in under 4 minutes

Step 3 · Only then

- The dive structure (camps, surfacing, depth record)
- Dice Forge and hero levels
- 4 classes
- Daily Dive
- Store and ads last

Message to start the new chat with: "We're building Dice & Dive in Unity (2D, portrait). Read the attached brief. Start with Step 1 only: a standalone Dive Roll scene with 5 dice, hold and reroll, combo detection, multipliers from the odds table, and a Dive Deeper button with the 2+ skulls bust rule. Put every number in one ScriptableObject so we can tune it live."

10. SOURCES & RISKS

What's Proven, What's a Bet

1. Cup Heroes Game Design Inspiration Brief (user-supplied teardown)
2. PocketGamer.biz: Balatro nears $4.4M on mobile
   https://www.pocketgamer.biz/balatro-nears-44m-on-mobile-amid-a-sudden-spending-surge/
3. Automaton: Space Rock Breaker (Plinko-based ore processing)
   https://automaton-media.com/articles/newsjp/space-rock-breaker-20251224-388202/
4. Adapty: Soul Knight IAP pricing and revenue estimate
   https://adapty.io/paywall-library/soul-knight/
5. PocketGamer.biz: Archero 2 makes $32.8M in its first 30 days
   https://www.pocketgamer.biz/archero-2-makes-328m-in-first-30-days-from-player-spending
6. AppMagic 2025 monetization report (summary): roguelikes +26.2% YoY
   https://gamedevreports.substack.com/p/appmagic-mobile-games-monetization

Combo odds and the bust rate were computed for this brief by counting all 7,776 outcomes of 5 six-sided dice. Market figures are third-party estimates, not developer disclosures.

Risks

- **Combo scoring may feel too familiar** (any dice-poker game). Mitigation: the boons that bend dice and the Dive Deeper risk are ours
- **Real dice physics on mobile** is fiddly: dice can stack, clip or take too long to settle. Prototype it first
- **Manual specials could make auto feel bad.** Keep the manual bonus small (+1)
- **The name**: check 'Dice & Dive' in the app stores before investing in art

Not proven yet

- That auto-battle players want a hold/reroll decision at all
- That 19.6% bust is the right amount of fear
- The x2–x25 multiplier curve